NIKE X NBA

(1A)

RUN IT UP

RUN UP A CHECK

RUN THAT SHIT UP

RUN UP THE SCORE

NBA owns the sport. Nike owns the market. Don't be nice, don't be humble. Don't dance around what "beauty" is, and don't you dare try to redefine it for your liking. 2 points is 2 fucking points. A win is a win. And trust, there ain't nothing else like it. Nothing else resembles it, don't nothing else replace it. If it's the 3rd quarter and you up 14, what you gon do? Run that shit up. The competition can catch feelings all they want, as long as they stay right where they are. Ain't no such thing as approachable out here in between these lines. RUN. IT. UP.

They get a big lead in the 1st, then start to get comfortable? **RUN IT UP.** Come back on em.
They bring out the new moves, not knowing you been in the gym all summer? **RUN IT UP.**
They debut some new innovation, not knowing you been in the lab all summer? **RUN IT UP.**
Just got paid? You saw Lebron get 40, 12, and 11 last night on TNT, and now you at Foot Locker? **RUN UP A CHECK.**
They tried to say you not from there? They hatin? The media won't shut up? **RUN IT UP.**
You doing everything in you life on behalf of him? **RUN IT UP.**

Notes/Other Explorations:

GET TO A BUCKET
SHOTS UP
GET SOME SHOTS UP
PLAYGROUNDS
LIFE IMITATES BALL

YOU GOTTA PUT A HAND UP
YOU GOTTA GET HELP

YOU NEED HELP

YOU GON GET CROSSED
NEVER GOT CROSSED, NEVER PLAYED D
IF YOU PLAY D, YOU'RE GONNA GET CROSSED
PLEASE PLAY DEFENSE

NOT HERE TO IMPRESS
GOT NO INTENTION OF IMPRESSING YOU
GOT EVERY INTENTION OF PRESSING YOU

10 FEET HERE, IS 10 FEET WAY OVER THERE TOO.
10 FEET UPTOWN IS 10 FEET DOWN SOUTH, TOO.
10 FEET, 20 SNEAKS.
10 FEET, 10 PAIRS.

BEAT THEM FOLKS
HIT THEM FOLKS UPSIDE THE HEAD
CROSS THEM FOLKS

MOUSE IN THE HOUSE
PLAYAZ BALL

GO HEAD
GO OFF

GET OFF ME
CANT NOBODY HOLD ME
I GET MINES
I'MA PROBLEM
RIGHT BY YOU

DON'T COME IN THE PAINT
RUN THEM POCKETS
GET THAT BAG
GET TO A BAG
GET A BAG

(1B)

LIFE IMITATES BALL, NOT THE OTHER WAY AROUND. THIS RELIGION DOESN'T REST. WE WAKE UP TO PRAY IN THE PAINT. WE GET READY FOR BED BY KNEELING AT THE BASELINE. OFF-THE-DRIBBLE SEASON, OFFER SEASON, BOUT-TO-GO-OFF SEASON, OFF THE BACKBOARD SEASON.

ANYTHING BUT “OFF SEASON”. WE GET BUSY TWENTY-FOUR SEVEN, THREE SIXTY-FIVE, AT 10 FEET AND ABOVE. THIS GAME BLEEDS INTO EVERYTHING WE DO, WAY BEYOND THE FIRST AND LAST WHISTLE. PLAY IT, LOVE IT, LIVE IT, DRINK IT, BUY IT, WATCH IT, DEBATE IT, IMITATE IT. BUT HOWEVER YOU GET DOWN, RUN IT UP.

(2)

THE HOLY ARENA. LIGHTS FLASHING, CHATTER HEAVY, 2 DOZEN THOUSAND SEATS FILLED. THIS ARENA CAN BE HUGE THESE DAYS, AND WE CAN COVER IT FROM ANY ANGLE IMAGINABLE. BUT WE WON’T DO THAT. BECAUSE THIS LEAGUE IS NOT DEFINED BY ITS PHOTOGENIC NATURE, IT’S DEFINED BY MATTERS OF INDETERMINABLE PHYSICS. WE CHERISH OUR COMFY PERCH, BUT IN THE PROCESS WE MISS THE BEAUTIFUL BRUTALITY OF IT ALL. THE THICK, BODILY CLANG THAT NECESSITATES TWO POINTS. DON’T COME THROUGH THE PAINT LIGHTLY, THAT’S MOST DEFINITELY A BLACK AND BLUE. LOOK AROUND YOU, IT’S MOSTLY BLACK AND BROWN. OUR VANTAGE IS REAL, OUR VANTAGE HURTS. THE GAZE OF “THE GAME” IS NOTHING WITHOUT THIS PROXIMITY. WE REPORT LIVE FROM THE FLOORBOARDS AND DRAWSTRINGS.

(3)

LET’S TALK ABOUT THE “REAL” FOR A SECOND. WE DON’T CARE ABOUT NO “REAL” PLUS MINUS, THERE’S NOTHING ICONIC ABOUT THAT SHIT. WE CARE ABOUT THE REAL ONES. THE ONES WHO SHOW US WHO THEY REALLY ARE, AND WHO THEY’VE ALWAYS BEEN. NOT WHO THEY’RE TRYING TO BE. EVERYTHING THEY BROUGHT TO THE LEAGUE WAS BORN FROM AN OVERTIME THRILLER ON THE CEMENT OUTSIDE THE PROJECTS. A FLOORBURN ON THE SUBURBAN DRIVEWAY. A BROTHERHOOD FORGED ON THE PREP CIRCUIT. A CLEAR-THE-BENCH BRAWL IN A POORLY FUNDED COMMUNITY REC CENTER. THE “REAL” THAT WE’RE TALKING ABOUT IS THE EXUBERANCE OF YOUTH, THE ZEAL OF EARLY RISK, REFINED FOR THE MAINSTAGE. THAT’S WHAT “REAL” IS.
“I’MA FIGHT YOU, IF YOU CROSS ME.”
“I’MA CROSS YOU, IF YOU REACH”.
“I’MA BUST YOUR ASS, EVEN THOUGH I LOVE YOU.”
“I’MA GO OFF, BECAUSE I HAVE TO.”
NONE OF THAT STARTED RECENTLY. REMEMBER: Y’ALL JUST GOT HERE. THEY BEEN DOING THIS.

(4)

YOU CAN'T SMELL IT, CAN YOU? YOUR SPATIAL RELATIONSHIP TO THE GAME IS PRETTY WEAK, WE GET IT. YOU STILL TALKING ABOUT "GOATS" AND PPG AND ALL THAT, BUT YOU NEVER REALLY BEEN THAT CLOSE TO IT. THAT'S NOT "GLITZ", FAM. THAT'S NOT A COUPLE EXTRA PHOTOSHOP LAYERS. THIS IS THE MUSK OF SWEATY OBSESSION SITTING RIGHT ON YOUR TOP LIP. THIS IS THAT DOWN-10-AT-HALFTIME STENCH. YOU MAY HAVE GOTTEN USED TO 1080P, BUT ON THE COURT, BENCH, LOCKER ROOM— ALL THE PLACES WE'RE GONNA BE— YOU DON'T REALIZE THERE A NATURAL HAZE. A TOUCH OF HUNGER AND DESIRE JUST SITTING IN THE AIR. I DON'T KNOW WHAT YOU THOUGHT, BUT KILLER MENTALITIES AREN'T CLEAN. THEY'RE DEFINITELY NOT CLEAN LIKE YOUR BULLSHIT STAT SHEET NARRATIVE. THEY'RE MESSY AND GRITTY AND WHITE HOT. IF YOU WANT TO CAPTURE THAT, YOU CAN'T BE AFRAID OF A LITTLE STINK.

(5)

PLAYERS DON'T MAKE "STATEMENTS", IT DOESN'T WORK LIKE THAT. THEY JUST CONSTANTLY HAVE THINGS TO EXPRESS. IN THE SAME WAY THEY DON'T TAKE PLAYS OFF, THIS LIFESTYLE IS ONE ENTITY. THEY EMBODY THIS "LIFE IMITATES BALL" DOCTRINE AS THEIR OFF-COURT STYLE HAS BECOME SYNONYMOUS. THE FULCRUM OF THEIR PERFORMANCE ON THE HARDWOOD IS THE PERFORMANCE BEFORE THEY EVER STEP FOOT ONTO IT.

(6)

A CITY ON YOUR BACK. A PEOPLE ON YOUR BACK. THE COURT IS THE GRAND PULPIT AND A 33 & 15 NIGHT IS A SPEECH ON BEHALF OF THAT NAME AND NUMBER. A 11-3 RUN IS A WARCRY, PEOPLE KNOW THIS. THERE HAS **NEVER** BEEN SUCH A THING AS "FAN GEAR". WHEN PLAYERS PERFORM AND CONNECT WITH THE SPECTATOR, THAT TEAM LOGO IS THE RENDEZVOUS POINT. WE GRAB HOLD OF THAT FEELING AND ALLOW IT TO EFFORTLESSLY SEEP THROUGH STYLE, USING THE ON-COURT GEAR AS A FOUNDATION FOR STREET-LEVEL LOOKS.

(7)

WE KNOW WHO WE'RE NOT. BUT MORE IMPORTANTLY, WE KNOW WHO WE NEED TO KNOW. OUR PLAYERS GET TO A BUCKET, OUR ARTISTS GET TO A FEELING. WHEN IT COMES TO THE BASKETBALL LANDSCAPE, EACH ARTIST IS AN EXPERT OF THEIR OWN EXPERIENCE. WE CENTER THEM IN TWO SITUATIONS:

(8)

“WHEN DID YOU FALL IN LOVE?” EVERYBODY MIGHT NOT WANNA ANSWER, BUT *THEY KNOW.* THE MOMENT WHEN YOU FALL IN LOVE WITH THE GAME IS THE MOMENT THAT THE OBSERVABLE UNIVERSE EXPANDS OUTWARD, THIS IS FACTUAL. WE GIVE OUR LIVES TO THIS GAME AND FOR SOME, THE PLAYERS ARE THE SOLE REASONS THEY FELL IN LOVE. THAT’S THE QUESTION THAT WE MUST GO FORWARD WITH. WHEN THEY TELL US, WE LISTEN AND EXECUTE.

(9)

AIN’T NO HANDOUTS. AIN’T NO BACKDOOR DEALS. AIN’T NO “COAXING”. WE JUST FINNA HIT UP PEOPLE WE ROCK WITH, PEOPLE THAT ROCK WITH US, AND LET THEM DO THEIR THING. THEY ALREADY KNOW OUR NARRATIVE, WHERE OUR STORY ORIGINATES, BUT ITS TIME FOR THEIRS TO EXIST RIGHT WITHIN THAT. THEIR PERFORMANCES, THOUGH NOT ON-COURT, ARE **JUST** AS IMPORTANT TO THE FABRIC OF THIS DOCTRINE. WE’LL JUST MAKE SURE TO BE THERE, AND PAY ATTENTION.

(10)

IT IS WHAT IT IS. CAPTURING THE RAW ESSENCE OF THE GAME REQUIRES BEING A FLY ASS FLY ON THE WALL. THAT 94’ X 50’ COURT IS THE NUCLEUS OF AN ENTIRE CULTURE AND YOU EITHER KNOW WHAT THAT LOOKS LIKE OR YOU REFUSE TO SEE IT. WE EMBRACE IMPERFECTIONS, WE REJECT ANY FIXATIONS ON POST-PRODUCTION. WE KNOW OUR CLIENTELE AND WE CREATE ALONGSIDE THEM. WE GOT EVERYTHING WE NEED ALREADY, COUSIN. IT IS WHAT IT IS, AND THE GOAL IS TO BE *WHERE* IT IS.